



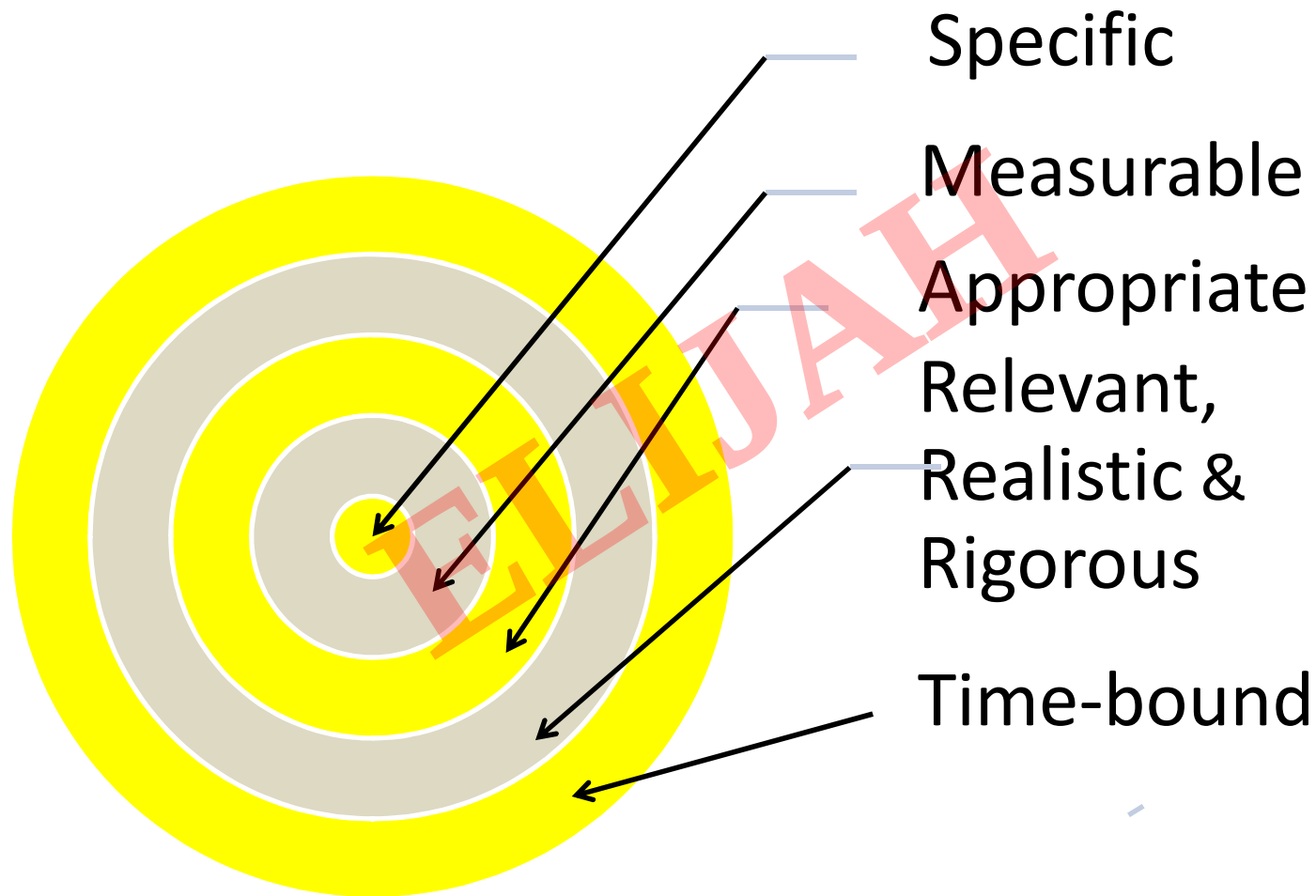
GOAL SETTING AND TIME MANAGEMENT

Goal setting

- Allows you to choose where you want to go in a student and what you want to achieve.
- Gives you long-term vision and short-term motivation.
- Involves using your present achievement data to set target goals for personal improvement.

- Set goals for different aspect of your life: spiritual, family relationship, academics.
 - For example, what score do you want in a particular course?
- Write your goals down where you can see them.
- Set your targets in clear terms.
 - Don't write "I want to study more"; rather "Get up at 4.30am to revise for one hour every day".
 - Similar targets can be set for prayer, motivational reading, hobbies, etc
- Begin to work towards achieving them.
 - Sleep early if you want to wake up early to study by giving up activities
 - Give up movies to attend tutorials

SMART GOALS





Time

Time is a limited, investible, non-renewable resource.

Time cannot be saved for future use

Each activity requires a minimum quantum of time

Time has a value like currency

Time management:

It is the proper use of available time for the accomplishment of set tasks.

It is managing ourselves in relation to time.

It is setting priorities and taking charge of your situation and time utilization.

Time management is an essential skill in the modern world where several activities have to be crammed into each day

Time management devices include *timetable, organizer, timepiece, etc*

Principles of Time Management

1. Set goals and establish priorities early
2. Spot the Time Wasters
3. Think quality not quantity of Time
4. Organize yourself for success – prioritize, stay healthy in body and mind, act purposefully and positively.

Principles of Time Management

5. Write a daily time schedule: - *Time, Activity, Priority* (by importance or urgency)
- **Very important.**
 - **Important**
 - **relatively unimportant**
7. Put ALL recurring tasks on your timetable

Time management strategies

□ Making a to-do list

Do not face a day without a clear idea of your targets for that day. Include other activities in addition to routine things like lectures and practicals.

You can make your list at night, while planning for the next day, or very early in the day.

□ Prioritization

Determine which [of the many items you have pencilled down] are absolutely necessary and which must be done as soon as possible.

This is what is meant by prioritization, a ranking or ordering of things according to their importance or urgency.

❑ Time budgeting and Time-tabling

Determine how much time you can afford to invest on an activity but be sure to include all your major activities, including rest and recreation.

Your prioritization may be helpful here: you may want to spend more time on activities that you consider more important but allocate only the time you need.

Factor into your time plan possible delays and foreseeable problems.

Time-tabling: things to consider



WHO AM I?

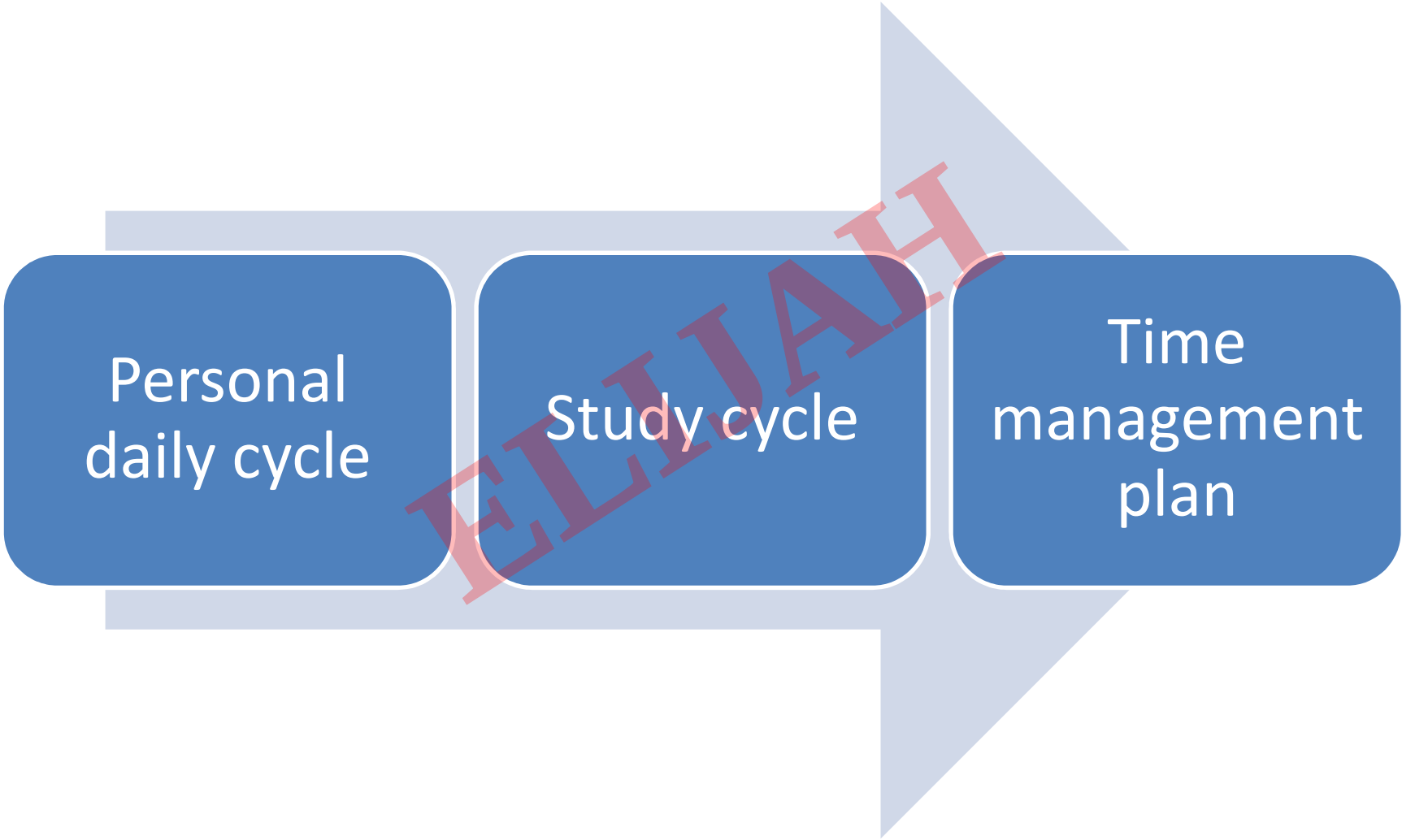
- What subject(s) do I like/detest? Why?
- What time(s) and for how long do I like to study?
- Where and in what conditions do I like to study?

More things to consider

WHO AM I?

- When and for how long must I sleep in a day?
- What activities (sports, social, religious) do I like to participate in?

Account for the following in your time-table



Personal
daily cycle

The diagram consists of three blue rounded rectangular boxes arranged horizontally. The first box on the left contains the text 'Personal daily cycle'. The middle box contains 'Study cycle'. The third box on the right contains 'Time management plan'. A large, light blue arrow points from the left towards the right, passing behind the boxes. A red diagonal watermark with the text 'FELTIAH' is overlaid across the middle box.

Study cycle

Time
management
plan

Your Time- Table must include:



period & hours of sleep required;
time required for eating; praying/fellowshipping; recreation;
moving from residence to lectures, etc



time & hours for lectures, tutorials & practical work



period and hours required for study each day/week to
cover ALL COURSES

A Realistic Time Table...

Should:

- be pragmatic
- account for all your courses & necessary activities
- account for your individual attention span
- be adaptable in response to exigencies
- reflect your essential personality in content & design
- be a guide, a tool

Should
not:

- be too detailed
- be too scanty
- be made to impress
- ignore any subject or major activity (social, sporting, religious)
- be a distraction

Your time-table

Make your personal time-table.

Use the University time-table as a framework.

Utilize your free time on the university timetable for preparation or revision

Use the timetable below as a template

Comprehensive Timetable

[illegible]

❑ Elimination of waste

Time is so precious that one cannot afford to waste it.

Whenever you find yourself unoccupied, ask: *what am I investing this time in?*

You need to give up some less productive activities to buy time for the more important things.

Time saving devices can help maximise your use of time: taking a taxi, using ATMs or mobile banking, using a telephone

□ Task sharing

Some people have time management challenges because they get involved in too many activities. So do not bite more than you can chew.

Our priority tasks can also present time management challenges. E.g., *an assignment for a course might require students to read several books and online material, do site visits and conduct some interviews.*

At such times, students can form study groups and share the tasks. Using this scheme, each student does two activities instead of four.

The *right attitude* is of prime importance in using task sharing as a time management strategy.

❑ Multitasking

Multitasking: a mode of operation offered by an operating system in which a computer works on more than one task at a time.

It can also mean the simultaneous management of two or more tasks by a person.

A student can set an action in motion, first writing up an assignment that must be word-processed, giving that assignment to a typist to be word-processed while working on another assignment

□ Re-scheduling

Despite all efforts to invest time wisely, there may be some important activities that cannot be accommodated on a particular day.

Such will have to be rescheduled appropriately, i.e. new times will have to be fixed for them.

Of course if they are not absolutely important, you might consider leaving them out altogether.

Problems and Solutions for Proper Time Management

❖ Personal

- Set priorities
- Be organized
- Spend some time on leisure

❖ Psychological

- Have self discipline
- Learn to say “No” when necessary
- Believe in team work
- Have a watch on the work entrusted

Problems and Solutions for Proper Time Management

❖ Social

- Allot some time for recreation: to spend with parents, nature, to love, to listen, to dream and to think
- Beware of and avoid time wasting relationships and pursuits

❖ Procrastination

Postponement is mainly due to a lack of interest or pleasantness in doing things.

Tips for Successful Time Management

Do things with concentration, dedication and commitment and not in a careless manner.

Trust others and distribute works to others (group activities)

Never think about unnecessary things and never be a in other people's matters

Postponement of planned events is an avoidable bad habit

Tips for Successful Time Management

Breakdown your goals into smaller tasks with manageable steps

Be punctual

Hurrying up is not always the best way of doing a thing faster

Don't forget or misplace things

Use a calendar/ Get organized

TIME MANAGEMENT

Time is life, do not waste it

Identify major thieves of time and eject them

Make a realistic list of things to do and act on it

Eliminate unnecessary activities

Memory aids such as notes, phone recording are useful

Analyze how time is spent

Never take on more than is necessary, learn to say no

Analyze yourself and operate within your strengths

Get on by being organized

Employ a program of physical and mental fitness

Manage backlog

Employ a schedule or planner to chart the way ahead

Never cease striving to become more efficient and effective

Treat each day as your last, maximize it.